CULTURAL RELEVANCE & BILINGUAL SCAFFOLDING

IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Victoria Park Academy Shenzhen — CIE IGCSE Computer Science (0478)

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PEDAGOGICAL PRINCIPLE | 教学原则

Students understand abstract Computer Science concepts more deeply when those concepts are anchored in familiar, culturally relevant contexts. For Chinese

For EAL learners at VPA, this means drawing upon the digital platforms, technologies, and daily experiences that students already navigate with confidence. These familiar anchors reduce cognitive load, accelerate comprehension, and enable students to construct more sophisticated and precise responses in English examination settings.

当抽象计算机科学概念植根于学生熟悉的、与文化相关的情境时，学生能更深入地理解这些概念。对于 VPA Shenzhen 的中国 EAL 学习者而言，这意味着利用学生已经能够熟练运用的数字平台、技术和日常经验。这些熟悉的锚点减少了认知负荷，加快了理解速度，并使学生能够在英语考试环境中构建更复杂和精确的答案。

CULTURALLY ANCHORED EXAMPLES IN THE CURRICULUM | 课程中的文化锚定示例

EXAMPLE 1: WECHAT PAY / ALIPAY — Digital Currency & Encryption

微信支付 / 支付宝 — 数字货币与加密

Topic (主题): 1.3 Data Security / Encryption (数据安全 / 加密)

Context (情境): Students use WeChat Pay and Alipay daily. The curriculum uses these platforms to explain:

- QR code generation and one-time tokens (一次性令牌)
- SSL/TLS encryption in payment gateways (支付网关中的 SSL/TLS 加密)
- Public and private key pairs (公钥和私钥对)
- The difference between encryption and hashing (加密与哈希的区别)

Exam Link (考试链接): Students can explain encryption using a concrete example they understand, then generalise to CIE marking points.

EXAMPLE 2: BILIBILI — Content Delivery, URLs & DNS

哔哩哔哩 — 内容分发、URL 与 DNS

Topic (主题): 3.2 The Internet & 3.3 Network Hardware

(互联网与网络硬件)

Context (情境): Bilibili's CDN architecture provides a relatable example:

- How video content is distributed across edge servers

(视频内容如何分发到边缘服务器)

- URL structure: protocol, domain, path, query string

(URL 结构：协议、域名、路径、查询字符串)

- DNS resolution from bilibili.com to IP address

(DNS 解析从 bilibili.com 到 IP 地址)

- The difference between client-side and server-side processing

(客户端处理与服务器端处理的区别)

Exam Link (考试链接): Students describe DNS and URLs using Bilibili as a worked example, then apply the same logic to generic CIE questions.

EXAMPLE 3: CHINESE NEW YEAR MESSAGE TRAFFIC — Packet Switching

春节短信流量 — 分组交换

Topic (主题): 3.1 Data Transmission / Packet Switching (数据交换 / 分组交换)

Context (情境): During Chinese New Year (春节), billions of messages and red packets (红包) flood the network simultaneously. This illustrates:

- Why circuit switching would be impractical (为何电路交换不实际)
- How messages are broken into packets, routed independently, and reassembled (消息如何被分解为数据包、独立路由并重新组装)
- The role of routers in managing congestion (路由器在管理拥塞中的作用)
- Advantages of packet switching: resilience, efficiency, scalability

(分组交换的优势：韧性、效率、可扩展性)

Exam Link (考试链接): Students can explain packet switching by referencing a familiar annual event, then transfer that understanding to examination questions about network protocols.

EXAMPLE 4: CHINA e-CNY (数字人民币) — Blockchain vs Bitcoin

中国数字人民币 — 区块链与比特币

Topic (主题): 1.3 Emerging Technologies / Blockchain (新兴技术 / 区块链)

Context (情境): China's central bank digital currency (央行数字货币) provides a powerful contrast to decentralised cryptocurrencies:

- Centralised ledger vs distributed ledger (中心化账本 vs 分布式账本)
- Government-backed trust vs proof-of-work consensus

(政府支持的信任 vs 工作量证明共识)

- Permissioned blockchain vs permissionless blockchain

(许可区块链 vs 无需许可区块链)

- Environmental considerations of different consensus mechanisms

(不同共识机制的环境考量)

Exam Link (考试链接): Students can critically evaluate blockchain technology using a Chinese case study, demonstrating the higher-order thinking required for A* and A grades.

EXAMPLE 5: XIAOMI SMART HOME ECOSYSTEM — Embedded Systems & IoT

小米智能家居生态系统 — 嵌入式系统与物联网

Topic (主题): 1.2 Emerging Technologies / IoT & Embedded Systems

(新兴技术 / 物联网与嵌入式系统)

Context (情境): Many VPA Shenzhen students have Xiaomi devices at home:

- Sensors, actuators, and microcontrollers in everyday devices

(日常设备中的传感器、执行器和微控制器)

- The relationship between hardware, embedded software, and user apps

(硬件、嵌入式软件与用户应用程序之间的关系)

- Input-process-output cycles in automated home systems

(自动化家庭系统中的输入-处理-输出循环)

- Security and privacy implications of IoT networks

(物联网网络的安全和隐私影响)

Exam Link (考试链接): Students describe embedded systems using devices they interact with daily, then formalise their understanding for CIE assessment questions.

BILINGUAL SCAFFOLDING STRATEGY | 双语支架策略

The programme employs a systematic bilingual approach that goes far beyond simple vocabulary lists. The strategy has four layers:

本课程采用系统的双语方法，远不止简单的词汇表。该策略分为四个层次：

LAYER 1: KEY VOCABULARY WITH PINYIN | 第一层：带拼音的关键词汇

Each unit begins with a bilingual glossary containing:

- English term (英文术语)
- Simplified Chinese translation (简体中文翻译)
- Pinyin pronunciation guide (拼音发音指南)
- Contextual example sentence (情境例句)

Example (示例):

Encryption (加密 / jiā mì) — "The encryption algorithm protects data during transmission." (加密算法在传输过程中保护数据。)

LAYER 2: SENTENCE FRAMES FOR EXAM RESPONSES | 第二层：考试回答的句型框架

Students are provided with scaffolded sentence structures that can be adapted for different examination questions. These frames model academic English while allowing students to insert content confidently.

Example (示例) — Explaining an algorithm:

"The purpose of ___________ is to ___________. This works by ___________ until ___________. The advantage of this approach is ___________, however, one limitation is ___________."

(__________的目的是__________。其工作原理是__________直到__________。

这种方法的优势是__________，但其局限之一是__________。)

LAYER 3: CHINESE EXPLANATIONS OF ABSTRACT CONCEPTS | 第三层：抽象概念的中文解释

For topics that students typically find difficult, the curriculum provides full explanatory notes in Chinese. These are not translations of English notes but original explanations written to address common misconceptions held by Chinese-speaking students.

Topics covered (涵盖主题):

- Recursion (递归) — explained through the lens of Russian doll nesting, a culturally familiar image
- Object-oriented programming (面向对象编程) — explained using family hierarchy and inheritance concepts familiar from Chinese culture
- Boolean logic (布尔逻辑) — explained using gate-level diagrams with full Chinese annotation

LAYER 4: EXAMINATION LANGUAGE DECODING | 第四层：考试语言解码

CIE examination questions use specific command words that EAL students often misinterpret. The curriculum provides explicit training in decoding these terms:

CIE Command Word	Chinese Translation	What It Requires
CIE 指令词	中文翻译	要求内容
State (陈述)	说明 / shuō míng	Give a brief fact
Describe (描述)	描述 / miáo shù	Give a detailed account
Explain (解释)	解释 / jiě shì	Give reasons WHY
Compare (比较)	比较 / bǐ jiào	Identify similarities AND differences
Evaluate (评估)	评估 / píng gū	Make a judgment with evidence

CONNECTION TO EXAM PERFORMANCE | 与考试表现的联系

The culturally anchored, bilingual approach directly supports examination achievement in three ways:

1. DEEPER CONCEPTUAL UNDERSTANDING | 更深入的概念理解

Students who learn through familiar contexts form stronger mental models. They are less likely to rely on rote memorisation and more likely to apply knowledge flexibly in unfamiliar examination questions.

2. IMPROVED EXAMINATION LANGUAGE | 改善的考试语言

Sentence frames and vocabulary scaffolding enable students to express sophisticated ideas in accurate academic English, even when their general English proficiency is still developing.

3. REDUCED EXAMINATION ANXIETY | 减少考试焦虑

Students who have encountered concept explanations in their first language, and practised responses using scaffolded frames, enter the examination with greater confidence and clearer strategies.

DESIGNED SPECIFICALLY FOR CHINESE EAL LEARNERS | 专为中国 EAL 学习者设计

This approach is not a generic EAL strategy adapted for Computer Science. It is purpose-built for Chinese students preparing for CIE international examinations. Every cultural reference, every bilingual resource, and every scaffolded frame has been selected to bridge the specific gap between Chinese educational experience and British international assessment requirements.

这种方法不是为计算机科学改编的通用 EAL 策略。它是为在 VPA Shenzhen 准备 CIE 国际考试的中国学生专门设计的。每一个文化参考、每一个双语资源和每一个支架式框架都经过精心挑选，以弥合中国教育经验与英国国际评估要求之间的特定差距。

VPA SHENZHEN — ROOTED IN CULTURE, REACHING FOR EXCELLENCE

深圳维多利亚公园学院 — 植根文化，追求卓越

Document Reference: VPA-CS-0478-CUL-2026

Date: 2026